Manuel Moscoso-Rojas

PERSONAL DETAILS

School of Social Sciences and Government
Tecnológico de Monterrey
Ciudad de Mexico

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- **Assistant Professor**, School of Social Sciences and Government, Tecnológico de Monterrey. *October-2026*
- **Postdoctoral Researcher**, School of Social Sciences and Government, Tecnológico de Monterrey. *2025-2026*
- J-PAL Invited Researcher *2026-2028*

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, Brown University *2025*

- **Committee:** Rob Blair, David Skarbek, Rebecca Weitz-Shapiro, Pedro Dal Bó
- **Subfields:** Comparative Politics; International Relations

M.A. in Political Science, Brown University *2020*
M.Sc. in Economics, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana *2013*
B.Sc. in Economics, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana *2010*

RESEARCH FIELDS

Comparative Politics, Research Methods, Politics of Public Security, Crime Reduction

DISSERTATION

Policing in Wartime: The Politics of Uneven Security Expansion in Colombia (2002-2010)

Why do states provide security to some places and not others within their borders? Who are the primary beneficiaries of security provision in rural areas? How does the uneven distribution of security affect citizen-state relations? Despite renewed interest in understanding the states' uneven territorial reach, we know little about why states prioritize the expansion of their security apparatus to some places and not others and the consequences on state-citizen relations. My dissertation addresses these questions through a combination of original qualitative and quantitative data (surveys, survey experiments, archival research, and interviews) from Colombia.

PUBLISHED PAPERS

Preventing Rebel Resurgence after Civil War: A Field Experiment in Security and Justice Provision in Rural Colombia with Rob Blair, Michael Weintraub, and Andrés Vargas. *American Political Science Review*. Vol. 116-04. November 2022, pp. 1258-1277.

How can states prevent armed groups from exploiting local governance gaps to (re)establish territorial control during transitions to national peace? We report results from an experimental evaluation of Colombia's ComunPaz program, a scalable, inexpensive intervention that sought to replace rebel governance by harnessing complementarities between state and communal authorities and by improving security and justice provision in areas once dominated by FARC, the country's largest rebel group. We find that ComunPaz enhanced the quality of local dispute resolution, increased citizens' trust in (some) state institutions, and strengthened coordination between state and communal authorities. It also appears to have

reduced citizens' trust in, and reliance on, armed groups. The program did not, however, increase reliance on either state or communal authorities to resolve disputes, nor did it increase citizensâ trust in communal institutions. We discuss the implications of our findings for peace-building and state-building in countries transitioning from civil war.

Meso-organizations, relational capital, and rural producers' integration into the market in a context of violence with Luz Elena Orozco, Clemente Forero Pineda, and Victor Alonso Baldrich Mora. *Journal of Rural Studies*. Vol. 80. December 2020, pp. 391-402.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Policing in Wartime: The Politics of Uneven Security Expansion in Colombia (2002–2010).

State-Building through Policing: The Long-Term Effects of Police Expansion on Civilian Conflict Resolution Preferences.

War-Making and State-Building: Revisiting a Classic Debate in the Colombian Civil War.

Security Voting in Mexico. *With Sandra Ley*

Do temporary firearm bans reduce violent outcomes? Evidence from a quasi-experiment gun ban in Colombia *With Jorge A. Restrepo and Edgar Villa*

NON-PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Insecurity and hybrid organization forms: challenges and opportunities to construct social capital in post-conflict settings. with Luz Elena Orozco, Clemente Forero, and Eduardo Wills.

Insecurity and hybrid organization forms in rural zones affected by violence with Clemente Forero, Luz Elena Orozco, and Eduardo Wills. Chapter 4 (279-300). 2017. The Academy and the Peace Process.

Economic growth, armed conflict, and organized crime: Colombian evidence with Jorge A. Restrepo and Edgar Villa. Chapter 6 (181-219). 2014. Economic and social consequences of armed conflict in Colombia. ESRC/DFID Universidad de los Andes. Bogotá, Colombia.

RESEARCH AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies Dissertation Prize	*2025*
Center for Philosophy, Politics, and Economics Fellowship. Brown University	*2024-2025*
Conference Travel Fund. Brown University	*Spring/Summer 2024*
Governance Initiative. JPAL *	*Summer 2023*
CLACS Fellowship. Brown University *	*Summer 2023*
GPD Fellowship. Brown University *	*Summer 2023*
International Travel Fund. Brown University *	*Spring 2023*
Doctoral Research Travel Grant. Brown University *	*Spring 2023*
Conference Travel Fund. Brown University *	*Spring 2023*
Graduate School Fellowship. Brown University	*Summer 2021*
Graduate School Fellowship. Brown University	*Summer 2020*
Scholarship to undertake doctoral studies. Brown University	*2019-2025*
Scholarship to undertake doctoral studies. Fulbright-Colciencias	*2019-2023*
International Organization of Migration. Grant **	*2018*
UNDP Innovation Facility. Grant **	*2018*
British Embassy in Colombia. Grant **	*2018*
KfW. Grant **	*2016*
Fellowship Virginia Gutierrez de Pineda for Young Researchers. Colciencias	*2011*
Bachelor Degree in Economics - Honors	*2010*

~ ** Resources to fund dissertation ** Resources to fund rebel governance project*

TEACHING

Political Science Department. Brown University

Teaching Assistant for Paul Testa. Political Research Methods. UL. *Spring 2024*
Teaching Assistant for Peter Andreas. Politics of Illegal Global Economy. UL. *Fall 2023*

Department of Economics. Universidad Javeriana

Teaching Assistant for Andres Giraldo. Economic Growth. UL. *Fall 2009 and 2011*
Teaching Assistant for Jorge Gallego. Mathematical Economics. UL. *Fall 2009*
Teaching Assistant for Arsenio Pecha. Mathematical Economics. UL. *Fall 2008*
~ *UL: Undergraduate Level*

COMPUTER SKILLS

STATA (High), RStudio (High), Quarto (High), ArcGIS (High)

WORKSHOPS AS CO-ORGANIZER

Co-organizer of Mini-Conference on Democracy and Organized Crime (with Adee Weeler and Mariana Bustamante). APSA 2024 *September 2024*
Graduate Student Coordinator. Watson Institute Security Studies Seminar *Spring 2023*

CONFERENCES

Pre-APSA Political Psychology Conference, EGAP Latin America 4, WAPOR, and The Chicago School in Experimental Economics *2026*
La Triada *2025*
LAPSS, MPSA, APSA *2024*
REPAL *2023*
EGAP Learning Days. Uruguay *2018*
Ethnicity, Conflict, and Inequality. Brown University *2016*
Olympia Summer Academy, Cycle A: Conflict Political Violence *2014*

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

School of Social Sciences and Government, Tecnológico de Monterrey *2024-2025*
Pre-Doctoral Researcher
International Justice Mission *2023-2024*
Senior Advisor on Police Reform and Monitoring and Evaluation.
Panagora *2024*
Senior Advisor on Youth Violence.
National Planning Department *January 2018 -June 2019*
Advisor. Justice, Governance, and Defense Unit
Office of Attorney General *September 2017 - December 2018*
Senior Monitoring and Evaluation Consultant
National Planning Department *January 2014 - March 2017*
Advisor. Justice, Governance, and Defense Unit
Conflict Analysis Resources Center - CERAC *June 2011 - December 2013*
Researcher

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent), Spanish (Native)

Last updated: October 27, 2026